

Zaid Daghash

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Jordanian national born and raised in Qatar, holding a First-Class Honours BEng in Computer Systems Engineering from the University of Sheffield and an MSc in Cyber Security from Liverpool John Moores University (expected Distinction). CompTIA Security+ and Network+ certified, with practical experience in network security, security automation, SIEM, intrusion detection, embedded systems, and secure software development through academic projects, Capture the Flag competition, and independent technical work. Currently employed as an IBM Maximo Operator with the CHEC–ALCAT Joint Venture, gaining experience in enterprise systems, operational processes, and cross-functional collaboration within a large-scale infrastructure environment. A proactive and adaptable engineering graduate with strong analytical, technical, and problem-solving skills, committed to continuous learning and applying technology to solve complex real-world challenges.

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA: [Security+](#), [Network+](#)

COMPETITIONS

Capture The Flag (CTF) – National Cyber Security Agency (NCSA)

Rosewood Doha Hotel | Qatar

Nov 2025

KEY PROJECTS

Security Automation Tool

- Developed a Python SOAR utility to enrich IOC indicators via public APIs and generate triage reports.
- Automated noisy alert filtering and produced CSV/JSON summaries to speed SOC investigation workflows.

File Encryption & Security Tool

- Developed a Java-based GUI application that enables users to scan directories, view file metadata, and perform AES-256 encryption and decryption on files and folders.
- Implemented secure folder encryption with user-defined passwords and file integrity verification using SHA-256 hashing, with all actions logged automatically to a text file.

Offensive & Defensive Security Engineer Simulation: Penetration Testing and IDS Deployment

- Executed 5 distinct attacks (SSH brute-force, RCE on Drupal/LotusCMS, kernel privilege escalation, and Tomcat WAR deployment) against a target server using Kali Linux and Metasploit.
- Analyzed network traffic in Wireshark to extract attack signatures and created 5 custom Suricata rules to detect them. Identified a post-exploitation attack that cannot be detected by a network-based IDS, justifying the need for HIDS/EDR solutions.
- Configured Splunk to ingest server logs (auth.log, access.log) and formulated precise queries to pinpoint attack patterns (e.g., brute-force traffic, malicious web requests), effectively hunting for adversarial activity.

Reinforcement Learning Project

- Implemented and compared Q-learning and SARSA algorithms to train an autonomous agent in different grid environments with deterministic, stochastic, and multi-target reward systems.
- Designed and tuned hyperparameters (learning rate, discount factor, exploration rate) to analyze algorithm performance across 5000+ episodes.

EDUCATION

Master of Science (MSc), Cyber Security

Liverpool John Moores University – Oryx University | Qatar

Sep 2025 – Present

- **Relevant modules include:** Computer Security, Network Security, Information Security Management, Ethical Hacking, Secure Systems

Bachelor of Engineering (BEng), Computer Systems Engineering

The University of Sheffield | United Kingdom | First Class Honours (GPA: 4.0)

Sep 2021 – Jun 2024

- **Relevant modules include:** Introduction to Electric & Electronic Circuits, Digital Signal Processing, Mechatronics, Introduction to Systems Engineering & Software, Systems Engineering and Object-Oriented Programming, Computer Problem Solving and Object-Oriented Design, Systems Design and Security, Machine Learning, Computer Security and Forensics, Reinforcement Learning.

SKILLS

- **Cybersecurity Tools:** Wireshark, Nmap, Metasploit, Nessus, Splunk
- **OS:** Windows, Linux
- **Programming Languages:** Python, Java, C, MATLAB
- **Microsoft Tools:** Word, Excel, PowerPoint
- **Core Skills:** Analytical | Problem-Solving | Project Leadership | Cross-functional Collaboration | Adaptability | Communication
- **Languages:** English (Fluent), Arabic (Native)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IBM Maximo Operator

China Harbour Engineering Company Ltd. (CHEC & ALCAT JV) | Qatar

Jul 2026 - Present

- Operating IBM Maximo Enterprise Asset Management (EAM) system to support maintenance operations and maintaining accurate equipment/maintenance records.
- Generating operational reports and updating work orders. Coordinating with engineering and maintenance teams to ensure data accuracy.